

Inc. as the developer. Install the app. You can now 'Disable' your stock messaging app and get rid of the extra clutter in your app drawer. Setting Android Messages as your default messaging app is a fairly simple procedure. Just follow the prompts on Android Messages, post installation, as it will set itself as the default messaging application. All you need to do is click 'Ok'. Ridiculously simple, right?

4 SWAP YOUR KEYBOARD:

How about setting up a Stock Android Keyboard to compliment your new messaging app?

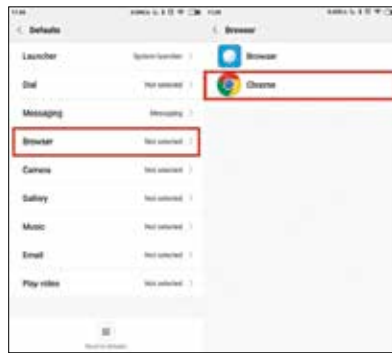
The Method: Go to the Play Store and install GBoard. Once the installation is complete, just open the app and follow the setup procedure which will lend itself into making GBoard your default keyboard. It's as easy as that!



Compliment your Google experience with Google's minimalist GBoard.

5 CHANGE YOUR BROWSER:

Chrome is one of the most widely used Internet browsers all over the world since it is so closely integrated to your Google account. It is also vastly acclaimed because of its simple, yet efficient interface. Most smartphones have Chrome pre-installed. If your device is not one of these, go ahead and download Google Chrome from the Play Store.



Google it up and make Chrome your default browser.

The Method: Download and install Google Chrome. Go over to your phone Settings and head to Apps. In the default apps section, set Chrome as your default browser and disable the stock internet browser on your phone to get rid of the unsightly clutter.

6 TIME TO REPLACE YOUR CALENDAR:

The Google Calendar app is easily available on the Play Store and also comes pre-installed on some smartphones from other manufacturers. This one is a slightly lengthy process, but it's another important step towards achieving your desired look.

The Method: Download and install the app from the Play Store. Set it up completely, then head over to your phone Settings and find Apps. Locate your phone's native calendar, click on it and then select 'Clear



The Google Calendar integrates your events with Google Assistant and allows easy voice searches.

defaults'. This will remove your stock calendar as the default app. Ensure that the next time you need to input an event you select Google Calendar from the list of apps. This will set up Google Calendar as your default calendar app for future actions as well.

Tip: Double notifications is going to be a problem at this point. To tackle this, click on 'More Options' in the same window and 'Turn Off Notifications'. Double notifications from both calendar apps will no longer be a problem after this little step.

7 GET THE PIXEL LIVE WALLPAPERS AND THE ICON PACK (OPTIONAL):

One of the recent additions to the Stock Android experience on the Pixel phones have been the 'Living Universe Wallpapers'. Since, we are aiming for a the most recent, near Stock Android look and feel, the live wallpapers are an absolute must-have.

These animated wallpapers, although not conventionally Stock Android, replicate the Pixel's modern look as they depict exotic locations and outer space. They add a much-needed vibrance to any smartphone.

The Method: Head to the Play Store (one last time) and download the Google Wallpapers app. The app already comes

equipped with a large variety of wallpapers, however, the ones we are looking for were absent. Fortunately, the good folks over at xda developers have the entire collection of the Pixel Live Wallpapers ready for installation. Search for the Pixel Wallpapers 2017 apk link (<https://dgit.in/Pixel>). Download and install it on your smartphone. Now, the Wallpapers app has been updated with these new Pixel wallpapers. Find them under the 'Live' category and set them to both home screen as well as lock screen to achieve the complete Pixel experience.

Tip: For this step, you will need to allow Unknown Sources to download apks as we did for the Pixel Launcher.

The icon pack we've found to resemble the Pixel icons the most is the Pixel Icon Pack 2 by Saurabh Gupta. Additional perk: it is available for free on the Play Store, while most other authentic-looking icon packs are paid.



The new Pixel Live Wallpapers are a visual treat.

Unfortunately, this particular icon pack works only with the Nova Launcher, and not with the Pixel Launcher.

Well, there you have it! A makeshift Stock Android experience on any smartphone from other manufacturers without having to root. Your phone should be pretty darn close to the Google devices at this point, in terms of looks. Don't let the lengthy process deter you from achieving a near-perfect Stock Android look. It is, certainly, worth it. 